from South Central Los Angeles to Ferguson, Missouri and Baltimore. In fact, the wars that America has since fought have been in places quite marginal to the dynamics of global capitalism. However much it deserves condemnation, what the Pentagon does is much less important to sustaining global capitalism than the US Treasury and Federal Reserve, which have become the pivotal institutions in coordinating the economic policies of the world's capitalist states.[7]

This has been confirmed by the global economic crisis that began in 2007–8, and is still very much with us. The Treasury and Federal Reserve's central role in global crisis management – from currency swaps to provide other states with much needed dollars, to overseeing policy cooperation among G7 central banks and finance ministries – has been front and centre, while the formerly highly-touted supranational system of European governance has proved dysfunctional in the management of global capitalism, ending all the easy ruminations about the euro displacing the dollar as the international reserve currency.

Amidst this crisis, the G20 group of capitalist states, initially called into being by the US Treasury as a means of 'failure containment' in the wake of the Asian financial crisis at the end of the 1990s has been given more prominence. The G20 was designed to get the major 'emerging market' states to take responsibility for the 'new international financial architecture'. This was seen as providing legitimacy for the continuing central role of the US in superintending a greatly expanded but increasingly volatile global capitalism.

Ever since the leaders of these states were summoned to Washington by George Bush in the ominous autumn of 2008, G20 communiqués have repeatedly renewed their 'commitment to refrain from raising barriers or imposing new barriers to investment or trade in goods and services … [and] minimise any negative impact on trade and investment of our domestic policy actions, including fiscal policy and action to support the financial sector'.[8] This is not to say that the US has ceded much operational control to the G20. The key policy decisions are made in Washington DC where the IMF and World Bank are headquartered, but even more decisively where the Treasury and Federal Reserve are located. The coordinated G20 fiscal stimulus in 2009 was significant, but mainly because it made it easier for the US Congress to accept the Treasury's initial plan for massive deficit spending. After Congress turned its face sharply against this in 2010, the centrepiece of policy shifted to the Federal Reserve's monetary policy of 'quantitative easing', and has remained there ever since.[9] The impact of this was felt as much internationally as domestically, as the Federal Reserve effectively acted as the world's central bank through its role in setting benchmark interest rates and streaming of dollars to foreign as well as US banks.